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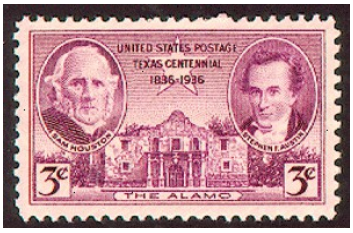
http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



MEETING CALENDAR

MAY			JUNE		
1	Juniors Combined Board of Governors & General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	5	Juniors Combined Board of Governors & General Meeting Program: "UN Stamps" by Charles Shelby	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
8	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	12	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
15	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	19	**SUMMER PICNIC** set-up at 6:00pm	6:30 pm
22	Juniors Program: "So You Want to Start a Stamp Business" by Ted Wenk	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	26	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
29	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm		May 10 - Happy Mother's Day June 21 - Happy Father's Day	
7/03 - Jrs, BOG, Show & Tell 7/10 - Auction 7/17 - Bourse 7/24 - Jrs, Program 7/31 - Bourse					

Cinco de Mayo - May 5

Editor's Corner

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

Flag Day - June 14

Here we are again. We thought something different would be in order this time. Instead of *'Hints from Heloise'*, how about '*Tidbits from your Editors'* ?

May is Fiesta - instead of spending money downtown, why not come to stamp club meetings and spend your money on stamps for your collection. May is also Mother's Day. Instead of taking your mother out, why not take your Editors out(or bring us a bouquet of stamps)? We're mothers, too! (just kidding, friends)

June is Picnic! Remember to get your tickets from Pat Richmond at the meetings, or email Fred Groth at <LTC519@satx.rr.com> and let him know how many tickets you need. Bring a friend to the Picnic, and get them an application. Volunteer to pay their dues til the end of the year! Hopefully they will like us enough to pay their own dues next year.

June is also graduation month. If you have an extra stamp, and don't know what to put it on, get a con-GRAD-ulations card and send it to any new grads you know. Your editor, Dora (proud Mom), has a daughter who is graduating High School on June 9th. Some of you may remember Brittany. If you need an address, we will be happy to give it to you.

We hope to see you at stamp club.

Your Editors, Dora and Lea

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

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Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Jane K Fohn
Vice President:	Judy Grant
Secretary:	Bro. Ed Loch
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	
Librarian:	

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Jane K Fohn
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Bob Joyce
One year term:	Pat Richmond
Two year term:	Skip Swinney
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Philatelic Society:	Jane K Fohn
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Circuit Books	Jane K Fohn

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

On the February 20-22 weekend, Pat Ryan, Judy Grant and I headed north for giant AmeriStamp/TEXPEX in Arlington. While there we saw fellow SAPA members Warren Crain, Lyle Boardman, and Fred Groth. All of us had a great time!

AmeriStamp Expo is the American Philatelic Society's annual winter event. This show is known as a venue for one-frame exhibits. The show has served as an introduction for new classes of exhibits such as the one-frame, illustrated mail, and, lately postcards.

This year AmeriStamp was combined with the Texas Philatelic Association's annual stamp event, TEXPEX. The two together doubled the fun. There were dealers, seminars, meetings, and many educational opportunities.

Judy was the "star" in our group. There is a picture of her looking through stamps at the stamps-by-the-bucket table on the APS website. She is in the upper-left corner. Judy found good pickings. (See page 6) To see more pics of the show, go to http://www.stamps.org/tours/ameristamp/

I looked at as many exhibits as I could cram into the weekend. An eye was kept on "Hillcountry Honkytonkin Rita: Labrador Retriever" to sight her award—she received a silver ribbon and the Women's Exhibitors silver medal. If Rita was still with us, her tail would have wagged to a blur with pride. One of the joys of a stamp show is seeing old friends, putting faces to correspondents, and meeting new people.

Home again. Back to my weekly "stamp fix" at our SAPA meetings. The club has a great deal to offer—come to our meetings and find out for yourself. The show-and-tells are spirited; programs are great; there is the regular monthly auction and a silent auction on the first and third Fridays; and the end-of-the month bourse. Pat Ryan and I have APS and Oklahoma Philatelic Society stamp circuits for your perusal. Plus, there are 2009 *Scott Catalogues* for reference, 2008 *Scotts* to be checked out, and the librarian will deliver a reference book to you upon request.

I look forward to seeing you on Fridays!

Jane Fohn

VP's CORNER

The Board of Governors is being combined with the first General meeting of the month. It will start at 7:00pm, and the Program portion of the meeting will start at 7:30pm. The combination of the two meetings was being done unofficially, and has worked out well. It means that the business of the club does not need to be repeated. All club members are encouraged to attend.

It has been pointed out that many of our club members do not drive at night, and thus miss the Friday meetings. If you would be interested in an occasional Saturday get-together to talk and exchange stamps, please call President Jane Fohn at 210-566-1436 or Vice-President Judy Grant at 210-694-4437. If we get enough response, we will start a Saturday program for any of our club members who wish to come.

Judy Grant

PROGRAM NOTES

May 22, 2009 "So You Want to be a Stamp Dealer" by Ted Wenk

Ted's first remark will be, "The best advice I can give you, is---- don't be a stamp dealer. The pay is so low that you can't believe you're doing it, but if you insist, I'll continue...." Well, Ted, that sounds encouraging (?)!

However, he is planning to talk to us about how to get started and also some of the pitfalls of the mail order business. It promises to be interesting.

June 5, 2009 "UN Stamps" by Charles Shelby

Since June is the birthday month of the UN, Charles will be giving his program to replace "Show and Tell" for the month of June, 2009.

Charles's talk will include a brief history of the United Nations. He will show a stamp album of one of the three cities where the UN has postoffices. Samples of postal items will also be shown. It sounds very informative, Charles. We are looking forward to it.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

Mailing Prices Change Monday, May 11

1st Class Mail	Price
Letters - 1st oz.	$0.44
Large envelopes - 1st oz.	$0.88
Parcels - 1st oz.	$1.22
Additional ozs.	$0.17
Postcard	$0.28
Stamped Card	$0.31
Stamped Envelope	$0.54
1st Class Mail International Postcards & Letters - 1st oz.	
Canada	$0.75
Mexico	$0.79
All Other Countries	$0.98

Reguardless of when purchased, Forever Stamps do not require additional postage to mail 1 oz. letters after the price change.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

MAY 16-17 TSDA SAN ANTONIO STAMP FAIR
Bourse at Norris Conference Center, 4522 Fredericksburg Rd. (at Crossroads Mall near NW I-410 and I-10, next to SuperTarget, lower level), San Antonio, Texas. Hours: Saturday 10 a.m. to 5 p.m., Sunday 10 a.m. to 4 p.m.

MAY 30-31 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Ramada Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Frwy, Houston, Tx. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm.

LONE STAR CHAPTER of the Èire Philatelic Association International meets 2nd Saturday between 2:00 PM and 4 PM every month in member's homes. Various aspects of Irish philately, and philately in general are discussed. All are welcome. For information call (210)658-9235.

"Ph"eatured "Ph"ilatelist Jack Virta

Jack and Carolyn Virta

Jack Virta was born on January 17, 1929 in Detroit, Michigan. His mother, Agnes still lives in Trenton, Michigan. He has one sister, Shirley Holland, 77, who lives in Trenton, Michigan.

When the stock market crashed in 1930, Jack's father, Jack Virta, Sr., had been a bank teller, but that job did not survive "The Crash". The family moved to Ecorse, Michigan where his father went to work for Metropolitan Life Insurance Company. He sold policies for a dime a week and he would go over to pick up the dime. Jack's mom was a stay-at-home mom. They stayed there until 1935 when the banking business got back on its feet. Then they moved to Lincoln Park, Michigan where his father became vice-president of the Security Bank of Lincoln Park.

Jack graduated from Ecorse High School in 1946. He went straight to college at Michigan College of Mining and Technology with a major in civil engineering originally. After 2 years he decided to go home to Lincoln Park, Michigan where he became a manager of Drome Appliance Store . He did that until September, 1950 when he joined the Air Force. A little "bird" told him that his draft number was coming up soon and if he didn't want to be drafted, he'd better go sign up for something he wanted.

Sure enough, 5 weeks after he was in the Air Force---Tada!!!!!---his mom wrote him and told him he had gotten his draft notice.He went to Lackland for basic training, then he went to supply school in Denver, Colorado. About 6 months later he was a corporal and was sent to Westover AFB in Springfield, Mass.

In October of 1952, he applied to flight school and was given orders to go to Greenville, Mississippi for flight school. The government at that time grounded all the planes. They kept only the foreign soldiers at Greenville, Mississippi. So, Jack was sent to navigation school at Ellington AFB in Houston, Texas. He earned his wings in 1952 and became a 2nd Lieutenant. When he left active duty in 1955, he remained in the reserves. In the reserves he served 23 more years and retired in 1978 as a Lt. Col. He spent his reserve time at Kelly AFB and Bergstrom as the Combat Support Squadron Commander in the 924th at Bergstrom

In October of 1955, when he left active duty, he came to San Antonio and went to Trinity University. He graduated in 1957 with a B.S. in Science of Light Construction, aka Home building and structures. He went to work for the Quincy Lee Construction, the biggest in San Antonio at the time, until 1961. Then, he went on his own and started J.J.Homes, Inc. where he built approximately 800 houses in San Antonio. At the apex of his business, he had approximately 122 employees.

In the early 1960's, when Jack had J. J. Homes, Inc., Carolyn came to visit her mother who was Jack's bookkeeper. They were married on September 22, 1962. (He was a smart guy!!!! He knew a ***GREAT*** deal when he saw it!!!!) Since that time they've had 5 kids, Valerie, Tommy, Cindy, Lisa and Laura, 10 grandkids and 1 great-grandkid----------and counting.

With the downturn of the economy in 1975, Jack changed to remodeling with Home Improvement, Inc. at 1007 Rittiman Road. He stayed there until the new buyer of the Ft. Sam Shopping Center decided to go up on the rent 125%. Jack said, "We're outa' here!" and decided to work out of his home.

Jack started collecting stamps as a kid. When he was approximately 8 or 9 years old, he was playing in the alley and found a box of German Inflation Stamps and thought he'd "hit it rich"! ...And a philatelist was born. He started trading them all over his neighborhood.

He continued trading stamps when he was in the air command and in remodeling, then in 1983 he started selling outright at the Rittiman Road location.

He joined SAPA in 1980. He was president in 82/83 and 2 more times in 2004 and 2005. He's still around bothering people. He is presently the auctioneer for the club as well as always being the "Last" out of the parking lot making sure that everyone else leaves the place safely

We tip our hat to you, Jack. You are truly a gentleman and scholar!! Thanks for being a part of the group.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

Program Notes - February 20, 2009
"UPU and Color Scheme" by Sam Rodger

Due to the fact that a great many of the regular club members were out of town for a stamp exhibit and were looking forward to hearing Sam's talk on color schemes of the UPU, Sam changed his presentation. He gave us a short history of the postal system using the book he is holding. The book is titled, *The Postage Stamps of the U.S.* by John N. Luff

The main purpose of the postal routes was to establish lines on the US map. It was essential that the government maintain a monopoly on the passageways for the success of the postal system. It was important that these navigable streams, roads and railroads be documented so that the government could levy taxes.

Benjamin Franklin established Boston Post Road, Mass. It is now U.S.#1. After the Civil War the government began to cobble some of the roads. The second best roads are in England.

Sam's brief talk about the history of the postal road systems was very well received and supplemented by other members in the group. It was a most informative session.

Part II (which was originally planned as Part I) on the Color Scheme in UPU, has been rescheduled for October 2, 2009. He has planned some full-color handouts for everyone who attends. Be there or Be Square.

Sam's programs are always lively and informative. Thanks, Sam.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

The following article (and a lot of other interesting stuff) can be found online at
tywkiwdbi.blogspot.com/2008/08/design-error-on-current-us-flag-stamp.html
The set of four stamps is on page one in the Editor's corner, illustrating Flag Day.

Design error on current U.S. flag stamp - 06 August 2008

"... The images, captured at different times of the day show the flag flying at sunrise, at midday, at sunset, and at night..." Close examination of the "evening" stamp, located in the lower-right quadrant of the official design featured on the U.S.P.S. website, reveals that the stamp apparently has one too many stripes..."

The size of the blue canton is such that exactly 7 alternating stripes run to the left of the canton. Because the top stripe is always red, the seventh stripe, the bottom of which lines up with the bottom of the blue field, is also red. The next stripe down would then have to be white. This stripe has the distinction of being the first stripe (from the top), that spans the full width of the flag.

It is this stripe which provides the vital clue as to the design error. The blue field rests *above* this long white stripe. If you counted from the top, this first long white stripe, is stripe number 8.

In the magnified view of the stamp image, there are 6 more stripes visible, before the image is clipped off. The small area located in the lower-left corner of the design is clearly white. By counting the stripes below the blue canton, starting with the white stripe (number 8) it is very evident that there is a 14th stripe and it is white..."

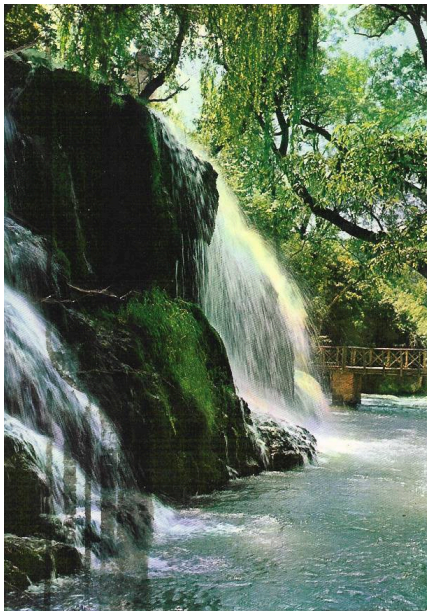
Since millions have already been issued, this will never be another "inverted Jenny," but it will likely rise in value and is certainly collectible. Thanks, Gerald at the Presurfer, for the heads-up this morning. I went to our local postoffice, which was sold out of self-adhesive and water-activated sheets, but did have the coil stamps, so I got a couple rolls of those.

Update per FOX news online: "The Postal Service plans to let the "Flags 24/7" series stay on the market, extra stripe and all, and will continue to be printed until the next stamp-price increase. "They will remain on sale as is," Betts said. "But we acknowledge the error." Darn.

Editor's note: Thanks to TYWKWDBI for showing me something I never would have noticed on my own.

Program Notes
March 20, 2009
"All the Colors of the Rainbow"
By Lea Senghaas

Lea began her program with a brief discussion of Iris the goddess of the rainbow, the messenger of the Olympian Gods. "Iris was often represented as the handmaiden and personal messenger of Hera. Iris was a goddess of sea and sky. For the coatal-dwelling Greeks the rainbow was seen spanning the sky and the sea, so therefore they believed that she replenished the rain-clouds with water from the sea." (Source: Dictionary of Greek and Roman Biography and Mythology)



One of the first items that Lea shared with us was a postcard of "Iris Cascade" in Spain. If you look closely, you can see the rainbow.

She went on to share with us stamps from Israel's Noah's Ark Story. If you remember, the rainbow in the Noah's Ark story is a sign of Promise.

It seems that the rainbow or a color-arc is used in many ways to convey hope and progress. There are rainbows on children's stamps, of course, but I was particularly impressed with the rainbows on the stamps that heralded scientific and technical advancements in the U.S. and around the world, from meteorology, Einstein and Space exploration.

When Lea was finished, Charles Shelby surprised her with a presentation of a "rainbow patch" from his time in the service in the 42nd Infantry Division. He also gave her a couple of pins with rainbows.

It appears that Lea was as surprised and pleased as the rest of us were. Thanks, Charles, that was a beautiful gesture.

It was evident from listening to Lea's program that she had done a great deal of research and planning. It was entertaining as well as enlightening. She even brought some rainbows for door prizes. Everyone enjoyed the program very much, Lea----------Thanks for all your efforts.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

Judy Grant

SAPA members at AmeriStamp/TEXPEX

Lyle Boardman

APS President's Challenge –Win $250 worth of APS products or services

Philately has gone to YouTube. The American Philatelic Society has initiated a program to promote philately on this venue. Videos presently uploaded are the following:

A Cat's Stamp of Approval Christmas Stamp Art
Due to the Civil War: Creation of Revenue Stamps
Formule 1 in Postal Stamps
Inverted Jenny Japanese Stamps
Presidents of the United States
Production of Stamps
Trains and Stamps

Look them over on the APS website at http://www.stamps.org/Videos/index.htm

This is all you need to do for the challenge. There are step-by-step directions for creating your short video on the website. Make the video and upload it to YouTube by June 30, 2009. Then email your entry to videocontest@stamps.org.

A panel of three APS accredited judges will choose the video that best promotes stamp collecting and the winner will receive a gift certificate for $250 worth of APS products or services and be featured in a future issue of The American Philatelist. The award will be announced at the APS Annual Meeting in Pittsburgh on August 8, 2009. You get to help the hobby and a $250 bonus as well!